

HOW COMMUNITIES CAN STOP DESTRUCTIVE DEVELOPMENT PROJECTS IN NAURU

Complete Community Opposition How-To

INTRODUCTION & FRAMEWORK

Community action shapes what happens to the land and the surrounding ocean of Nauru — and here the story carries a warning unlike any other, because this tiny island has already been devoured once by mining, and now stands at the centre of a global fight over whether to do the same thing to the deep sea. Nauru is one of the smallest nations on earth, a single raised coral island in the Pacific, and for a century it was strip-mined for phosphate — the fossilised residue of ancient seabirds — until roughly four-fifths of the island, the interior known as Topside, was reduced to a moonscape of jagged limestone pinnacles, uninhabitable, with the island's people crowded onto the thin coastal ring that is the only living land left. Nauru is one of the smallest nations on earth, a single raised coral island in the vast western Pacific, and for the better part of a century it was strip-mined for phosphate — the fossilised residue of countless ancient seabirds — until roughly four-fifths of the whole island, the interior known as Topside, was reduced to a barren moonscape of jagged limestone pinnacles, wholly uninhabitable, with the island's remaining people crowded onto the thin coastal ring that is the only living land left to them. The phosphate made Nauru, for a brief moment, one of the richest places per person on earth; then it ran out, the wealth was squandered, and the nation was left poor, scarred, and searching for revenue. The phosphate made Nauru, for a brief and giddy moment, one of the richest places per person on the entire earth; then it ran out, the accumulated wealth was squandered and lost, and the nation was left poor, deeply scarred, and searching desperately for revenue. Now, its old income dwindling, Nauru has become the sponsoring state for a company seeking to mine the deep-sea floor of the Pacific. Now, its old sources of income dwindling to almost nothing, Nauru has become the sponsoring state for a company seeking to mine the deep-sea floor of the wider Pacific — and has forced the world's seabed authority toward opening that frontier before the rules or the science are ready and has, through a legal manoeuvre, forced the world's seabed authority toward opening that frontier before the rules or the science are anywhere near ready — in a move that many, at home and abroad, see as the island preparing to repeat underwater the very catastrophe that ruined its own land in a move that many observers, at home and abroad, have come to see as the island preparing to repeat underwater the very catastrophe of extraction that ruined its own land above the water. This guide will be honest that Nauru is small and poor and genuinely needs revenue, that its own government is driving the deep-sea project, that the seabed lies in international waters beyond any one community, and that there is no landmark victory to point to; but it will show that the levers here — the memory of phosphate, the world's seabed governance, the precautionary principle, the market that will not buy, and the healing of the ruined land — are real. The levers here — the memory of phosphate, the world's seabed governance, the precautionary principle, the market that will not buy the metal, and the healing of the ruined land — are real and can be used.

The Nauruan story teaches two things about opposing destructive projects here, and this guide states both plainly. The first is the pattern that runs through every guide: not a single silver bullet, but the combination of every lever pressed together. The second is distinctly Nauruan, and it is what gives this guide its real force. **Because Nauru has already lived the full arc of extraction — the boom, the ruin, the bankruptcy, the moonscape — its own history is the most powerful argument against repeating it; and because the deep-sea project runs through the world's seabed authority, the precautionary principle, a growing coalition of nations, and a market that refuses to buy the metals, the levers reach the frontier from**

every side: the memory of phosphate, the seabed governance, the moratorium coalition, the market refusal, and the rehabilitation of the land. That combination — the memory of phosphate, the seabed governance, the moratorium coalition, the market refusal, and the rehabilitation — is the distinctive lever here, and this guide is built around it, because a nation that carries the scars of extraction on its own body holds, in that very wound, the strongest case against opening a new one.

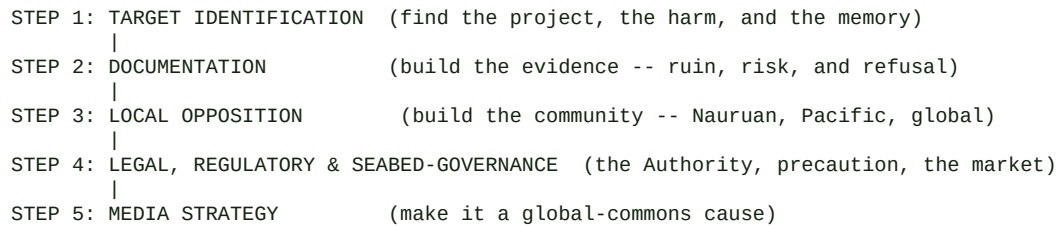
But the same story carries honest qualifications this guide states plainly and takes seriously. **Nauru is small and poor, genuinely needs revenue, and its own government is driving the deep-sea project.** With its land ruined and its old income gone, Nauru faces a real and painful shortage of ways to sustain itself, and its leaders argue, not without force, that mining the seabed is a more sustainable path to survival than further ruining what little land remains — so the deep-sea project is not simple villainy but a poor nation's search for a future. And because the government itself sponsors the project, opposition here is unusual: it comes as much from the wider Pacific, the world, and the deep sea's defenders, and from those Nauruans who question the path, as from any organised domestic movement. This guide does not pretend Nauru's need is not real, or that the seabed is any one community's to decide, or that the government is not the driver. What it shows is how, drawing on the memory of phosphate, the world's seabed governance, the precautionary principle, the market refusal, and the healing of the land, a community — Nauruan, Pacific, and global — can press the case against repeating catastrophe, while honestly holding the nation's real need for a future alongside the risk of ruining the sea.

Most people do not know HOW to use the levers a global frontier and a scarred history offer. They see the moonscape of Topside, the company's promises of seabed riches, the world's authority pushed toward opening the deep — and either accept extraction as the island's only fate or protest in ways that miss the real levers: the cautionary power of phosphate, the seabed governance, the moratorium coalition, the market that will not buy, the rehabilitation of the ruined land. The gap between the sea defended and the sea opened is here often a gap of method — the method of using the memory of phosphate, the seabed governance, the precautionary principle, the market refusal, and the rehabilitation together, and of holding the nation's need and the sea's protection together.

This guide shows what can actually be tried — inside the Nauruan reality as it is, which is a tiny, scarred, poor nation at the centre of a global frontier. It is written for the person — Nauruan, Pacific, or of the wider world — who sees the ruined land and the threatened deep, and who wants to know what can be done when a poor nation, needing revenue, prepares to repeat its own catastrophe on the sea. The answer is a qualified yes: the levers are real — the memory of phosphate, the seabed governance, the precautionary principle, the market refusal, and the rehabilitation — with the honest qualifiers that Nauru's need is real, the government drives the project, the seabed is no one community's alone, and there is no landmark victory to promise, only real levers and the work of pressing the case against repeating ruin. A note on who this guide is for, and on the spirit in which it should be used, because this case is unusual. It is for the person — Nauruan, Pacific, or of the wider world — willing to do the patient, fair, and often constructive work of pressing the case against repeating ruin through the world's governance and the island's own history, rather than the simpler work of condemning a poor nation. That is not a weaker form of action but, in Nauru's conditions, the only effective and fair one, because here the levers that genuinely deliver are the seabed governance, the coalition, the market, and the moral force of the phosphate memory, none of which is served by attacking a poor nation that sees the sea as its lifeline. Anyone tempted simply to blame Nauru should remember that it was colonial powers who stripped the island bare, that its need is real, and that the fair and reachable path runs through offering better alternatives while pressing the global case for caution. This guide is an honest map of that patient, fair, global-commons path — the path of pressing the case against ruin while honouring a scarred nation's genuine need.

The Strategic Framework

Effective efforts follow the same underlying pattern, whether the goal is to pause the deep-sea project or to heal the phosphate-ruined land:



These steps operate **simultaneously, not in sequence**. The evidence of ruin and risk feeds the seabed governance, the moratorium coalition, the market, and the world at once; the community — local, Pacific, and global — organises; a submission to the Authority, an appeal to the market, or a rehabilitation project is both pressure and a spur to the next. The community that runs all five together, each reinforcing the others, gives itself the best — if still difficult — chance of pressing the case against repeating ruin.

The Levers That Are Distinctly Strong Here

Every country's system has its own pressure points. Nauru's — a lived history of extraction, a global-commons frontier, a precautionary principle, and a refusing market — give a distinctive set:

- **The memory of phosphate.** Nauru's **own ruin by extraction** is the most powerful argument against repeating it on the sea — a distinctive, lived lever.
- **The seabed governance.** The **world's seabed authority and the "common heritage" of the deep** govern the frontier, and the premature push can be resisted there.
- **The moratorium coalition and precaution.** A **growing coalition of nations and the precautionary principle** press for a pause until the science is ready.
- **The market refusal.** The **buyers who refuse to purchase seabed metals** undercut the whole economic case for mining.
- **The rehabilitation and accountability.** The **healing of the ruined land, and the precedent of holding past extractors to account**, are real, constructive levers.

What This Guide Will Not Pretend

It would be dishonest to promise these levers prevail, or that Nauru's need is not real. There is **no landmark win**; Nauru is **poor and needs revenue**; the **government drives the project**; and the seabed is **no one community's alone**. This guide takes those limits seriously — it states them plainly, and it holds the nation's need and the sea's protection together — and shows how to use the real, distinctive tools this situation offers — the memory of phosphate, the seabed governance, the precautionary principle, the market refusal, and the rehabilitation — to press the case against repeating ruin, honestly acknowledging the poverty, the government's role, the global nature of the seabed, and the absence of a landmark victory.

HOW THE SYSTEM WORKS

You cannot pull a lever you cannot see. Before you spend a single week, map who actually decides the deep-sea project's fate, at which level, and where the leverage is real. And map where the memory of phosphate, the seabed governance, the precautionary principle, the market refusal, and the rehabilitation apply, because in Nauru a destructive project is met not chiefly through a domestic government that drives

it, but through the world's seabed governance, the coalition of nations, the market, and the island's own cautionary history.

The Levels of Decision

A Nauruan project runs through several levels, and — unusually — the decisive ones are largely global.

The government and the company. The **Nauruan government and the sponsored company** drive the deep-sea project, and the government, as sponsor, is the project's champion rather than a body to petition against it — so the leverage lies elsewhere.

The world's seabed authority. The **international seabed authority** governs mining of the deep ocean floor, the "common heritage of mankind," and is the arena where the premature push can be slowed and the precautionary approach pressed.

The coalition of nations. A **growing coalition of countries** — including Pacific neighbours — calling for a moratorium or precautionary pause is a distinctive lever on the frontier.

The market and the science. The **buyers who refuse seabed metals** and the **deep-sea scientists** who warn of irreversible harm undercut the project's economic and environmental case.

The community and the land. The **Nauruan, Pacific, and global community, and the ruined land awaiting healing**, are the constituencies — local, regional, and planetary — with a stake in the outcome.

The Journey of a Project

A Nauruan project — a deep-sea mining plan, or the ongoing question of the ruined land — moves from a sponsorship and a plan, through the seabed authority's process, toward the opened deep or the healed land, with the **memory of phosphate, the seabed governance, the precautionary principle, the market refusal, and the rehabilitation** able to intervene. **The seabed governance and the moratorium coalition are where the deep-sea push is best met, and the memory of phosphate is the argument that runs through all** — and using them together is the distinctive Nauruan approach. The distinctive levers are the **memory of phosphate, the seabed governance, the precautionary principle, the market refusal, and the rehabilitation**. Find out exactly where the project stands, and, crucially, **what deep-sea life or land would be lost, how the seabed authority and the coalition can be engaged, and how the market and the memory of phosphate can be brought to bear**, because those are where a project can genuinely be met.

Follow the Project, the Sea, and the Metal

Behind a project stand the government, the company, and the market for the metal. Trace who decides, who profits, who would buy, and — importantly here — **what deep-sea ecosystem or land would be lost, how the seabed authority governs it, which nations and buyers oppose it, and how the memory of phosphate and the rehabilitation apply**. Two questions unlock most Nauruan efforts: **What would be lost, and who globally can meet it?** and **Which lever — the memory of phosphate, the seabed governance, the precaution, the market, the rehabilitation — can press it?** The seabed governance, the moratorium coalition, and the memory of phosphate are, together, the heart of most such efforts here. Everything else in a Nauruan effort ultimately serves these: the documentation exists to establish the deep-sea risk and the phosphate memory; the broad community exists to carry them across the widening circle from island to Pacific to world; and the media exists to raise the stakes before the seabed authority, the coalition, and the market. Keep the seabed governance, the moratorium coalition, and the memory of phosphate at the centre of every submission, appeal, and campaign, and the effort retains a clear spine that

runs from the moonscape of a ruined island to the governance of the global deep, and that grounds the whole struggle in the plain, hard-won lesson of what extraction leaves behind.

The Overseers

Finally, know the bodies and forces that shape a project, because they are the levers — and most are global. The **government and the company**; the **world's seabed authority**; the **coalition of nations and the precautionary principle**; the **refusing market and the deep-sea scientists**; the **rehabilitation bodies and the accountability precedents**; and the **Nauruan, Pacific, and global community**. In Nauru, the **memory of phosphate, the seabed governance, the precautionary principle, the market refusal, and the rehabilitation** are the most distinctive levers, and most reach the frontier from beyond the island. Each is a separate front, and a project shown to threaten irreversible deep-sea harm, pushed through prematurely against the precautionary principle, and refused by the market, can genuinely be pressed — through the seabed authority, the coalition, and the world — though, honestly, Nauru is poor and needs revenue, the government drives the project, and the seabed is no one community's alone, and this guide will keep saying so, and keep holding the nation's need and the sea's protection together.

QUICK REFERENCE: SUCCESS RATES

Before you commit effort, calibrate honestly — and here that means acknowledging that Nauru is poor and needs revenue, that the government drives the project, and that the seabed is no one community's alone, even as the seabed governance, the moratorium coalition, and the memory of phosphate give real leverage. These figures are **directional, not guarantees** — patterns drawn from how frontier-extraction and seabed conflicts tend to go, not a controlled study. The decisive variables are whether the case can **document the risk and invoke the memory of phosphate**, whether it can **engage the seabed governance, the coalition, and the market**, and whether it can **hold the nation's need and the sea's protection together**. Where the risk is clear and the global levers are engaged, the levers here are real; but temper every figure with the honest knowledge that Nauru's need is real, the government drives the project, and the seabed is a global commons.

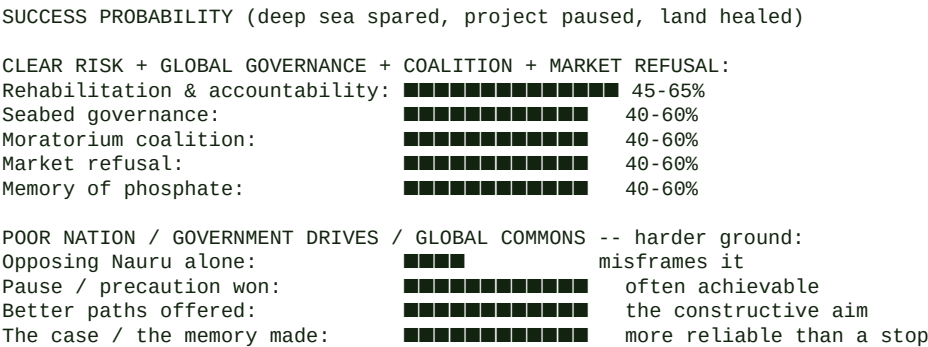
Individual Step Success Rates

Approach	Success Rate	Timeline	Cost	What "Success" Means
Documentation only	10–20%	weeks	low	Basis for every other step
Memory-of-phosphate argument	40–60%	months	low	The cautionary case made
Seabed-governance engagement	40–60%	months–years	low–moderate	The push slowed; precaution pressed
Moratorium coalition	40–60%	months–years	low	A pause advanced; nations joined
Market refusal	40–60%	months	low	Buyers refuse; the case undercut
Deep-sea science	40–60%	months	low	Irreversible risk established
Rehabilitation & accountability	45–65%	years	low–moderate	The land healed; past ruin owned
All levers together	40–60%	months–years	moderate	The push paused; the case made

Key insight: every step together beats any single one, and Nauru's real strengths are the frontier's global levers and its own history: the **seabed governance**, the **moratorium coalition**, the **market refusal**, the **memory of phosphate**, and the **rehabilitation**. Its constraints are specific and honest: Nauru is **poor and needs revenue**, the **government drives the project**, and the seabed is **no one community's alone** — so progress comes through the world's governance, the coalition, the market, and the island's cautionary history, not through a domestic government that champions the project.

*A note on cost: the levers here — a documented case, a governance submission, a market appeal, a rehabilitation project — cost mainly organisation and knowledge, and the science and the coalition can supply much of the analysis. The scarce resources are **organisation, the global and Pacific connections, and the technical and legal help** — much of it reachable through the world's ocean-defence networks. This shapes where a Nauruan effort should concentrate its energy. Because the decisive resources are the organisation to unite the widening circle of community, the connections to the deep-sea defence organisations, the moratorium-coalition governments, and the scientists who together can press the frontier, and the technical and legal help to engage the seabed authority — rather than the local numbers that other struggles require — an effort's most valuable investments are in building ties to the global ocean-defence networks and the Pacific coalition, and in marshalling the scientific and historical case. A small, well-connected effort that can document the deep-sea risk, carry the memory of phosphate, and reach the seabed authority and the coalition can accomplish far more than a larger one confined to the island. The resources that matter most are thus largely a matter of connection, evidence, and the moral force of the island's own history — all within the reach of a determined and well-networked community. And because Nauru's need for revenue is real, part of the work is offering the nation better paths — rehabilitation, sustainable revenue, accountability for past ruin — not merely opposing the sea's mining.*

Effectiveness Visualization



How to read this honestly. The levers that most change outcomes in Nauru are **the seabed governance, the moratorium coalition, the market refusal, the memory of phosphate, and the rehabilitation** — used together, and holding the nation's need and the sea's protection together. The governance, coalition, and market levers show the ceiling: a premature push can genuinely be paused, and the economic case undercut, through the world's governance and market. Nauru's poverty and the government's role show the honest floor: the nation needs revenue, and its own government drives the project. Most Nauruan efforts will sit between, and the honest lesson is that the levers here are real — able to pause the push, press precaution, undercut the market, and heal the land — but that a landmark stop is not assured, the nation's need is real, and the work is to press the case against repeating ruin while offering better paths.

Step Importance Ranking (When All Combined)

1. **The seabed governance and the moratorium coalition** — Nauru's distinctive frontier levers; where the premature push is met.
2. **The memory of phosphate** — the lived, cautionary argument that runs through all.
3. **The market refusal and the deep-sea science** — the economic and environmental case undercut.
4. **The rehabilitation and accountability** — the healing of the land and the reckoning with past ruin.
5. **The risk-and-memory case** — the documented risk and the cautionary history.

What These Campaigns Actually Show

A few honest patterns recur. **The memory of phosphate is a real argument** — a nation ruined by extraction is the living case against repeating it. **The governance can slow the push** — the seabed authority and the precautionary principle can resist a premature rush. **The coalition is growing** — nations, including Pacific neighbours, press for a pause. **The market refuses** — buyers who won't purchase seabed metals undercut the whole case. **But Nauru's need is real and the government drives it** — so the effort must offer better paths, not merely oppose. The through-line: **document the risk and invoke the memory of phosphate; engage the seabed governance, the coalition, and the market; heal the land and press accountability; and hold the nation's need and the sea's protection together** — because a community that does can genuinely pause the push and press the case, while being honest that Nauru's need is real, the government drives the project, and there is no landmark victory yet.

STEP 1: TARGET IDENTIFICATION

Every effective effort begins by finding the exact project and risk — and the leverage, which here runs through the world's governance and the island's history. Vague concern goes nowhere, and simply condemning a poor nation misframes it; an effort aimed at "this deep-sea mining plan, threatening irreversible harm to poorly-known ecosystems, pushed through the seabed authority before the science is ready, refused by the market, and repeating the very ruin phosphate wrought on this island" is a real, workable effort — the kind Nauru's distinctive levers can deliver. Answer five questions.

The Five Core Questions

1. **What would be lost?** This is the first question here. What **deep-sea ecosystem, or what more of the land**, would the project harm — the poorly-known creatures of the nodule fields, the ancient seabed, or the ruined Topside awaiting healing.
2. **How does the seabed governance apply?** How the **world's seabed authority, the "common heritage" principle, and the precautionary approach** govern the project, and where the premature push can be met.
3. **Which nations and buyers oppose it?** Which **nations in the moratorium coalition** and which **buyers refusing seabed metals** can be enlisted — the frontier's distinctive levers.
4. **How does the memory of phosphate apply?** How Nauru's **own ruin by extraction** bears on the case — the lived, cautionary argument against repeating catastrophe.
5. **How are the nation's need and the sea held together?** How Nauru's **real need for revenue** is honoured, and better paths — rehabilitation, sustainable revenue, accountability — offered alongside the case for the sea.

A Worked Example

Suppose a deep-sea mining plan threatens irreversible harm to poorly-known ecosystems, pushed through the seabed authority before the science is ready, while the ruined land at home awaits healing.

Working the five questions: **what would be lost? How does the governance apply? Which nations and buyers oppose it? How does the memory of phosphate apply?** And how are the nation's need and the sea held together? The drivers are the government and the company, with the seabed governance, the coalition, the market, the memory of phosphate, and the rehabilitation as the levers.

Within a season the effort has moved from "the deep will be mined and nothing can be done" to a real effort: document the risk and the science; engage the seabed authority and press precaution; enlist the moratorium coalition and the refusing market; invoke the memory of phosphate; and offer Nauru better paths — while honouring its real need. That is a workable effort suited to Nauru — one that reaches a global frontier through the world's governance and the island's own hard-won wisdom. Notice what the five questions accomplish, and how they suit a fight of this unusual character: they transform what might seem an impossible target — a poor nation's own government, driving a project in international waters, backed by a global company — into a set of specific, answerable questions, each attached to a lever that reaches the frontier from a direction the government does not control. The harm becomes documentable deep-sea risk. The governance becomes a reachable arena at the seabed authority. The opposition becomes a coalition of nations and a refusing market that the government cannot command. The memory of phosphate becomes a moral argument no official can wave away. And the question of the nation's need keeps the effort fair and constructive rather than a condemnation. That translation — from an unassailable-seeming target into a set of specific actions pressed through the world's governance, the coalition, the market, and the island's own history — is the first and most important thing a Nauruan effort does, because it moves the fight from the one arena where the community is weakest, a government that champions the project, onto the many arenas where the frontier can actually be met.

STEP 2: DOCUMENTATION — HOW TO BUILD AN UNASSAILABLE CASE

Documentation is the foundation everything else stands on — and here, where the case must persuade the seabed authority, the coalition, the market, and the world, sound evidence of the risk, the memory, and the refusal is decisive. A seabed regulator, a coalition government, a buyer, and a journalist all move on evidence — and in Nauru, a clear record of the deep-sea risk, the lessons of phosphate, and the market's refusal is precisely what an effort turns into a real result, so build it well. Build your file in three layers.

Layer 1: The Project, the Risk, and the Governance

Get the facts the case turns on. Identify the **project, the company, the sponsorship, and the deep-sea area** at stake, and — decisively here — the **environmental risk** and the **governance** that applies: the poorly-known ecosystems, the warnings of severe and irreversible harm, and the seabed authority's process and the precautionary principle. Much of this exists in the scientific studies, the seabed authority's own records, and the deep-sea defence organisations' analyses, and is reachable. Establish exactly **what the project is, what it risks, and how the governance applies**, because the risk and the governance are the case's foundation.

Layer 2: The Risk, the Science, and the Memory

Document the risk and the history. Establish the **deep-sea harm** — the threat to poorly-understood, slow-forming ecosystems, the warnings that impacts may be severe, irreversible, and unpredictable — drawing on **the deep-sea science and the seabed authority's own advisors**. And establish the **memory of phosphate** — the century of strip-mining, the ruined Topside, the boom and the bankruptcy — as the lived, documented case against repeating extraction. Photographs of the moonscape, the scientific warnings, and the historical record make both the risk and the cautionary memory undeniable.

Layer 3: The Risk, the Refusal, the Memory, and the Better Path

Finally, document the case and the honest alternative. Does the **deep-sea risk** show a real, irreversible harm? Does the **market refuse** the metals, undercutting the economic case? Does the **memory of phosphate** warn against repeating ruin? And — honestly — what **better path** exists for Nauru's real need: rehabilitation, sustainable revenue, accountability for past ruin? Each is a separate element, and together they make a case that presses the deep-sea push while honouring the nation's need. This is the layer that most often decides these efforts, because a documented risk, a refusing market, a cautionary memory, and a better path are exactly what let a community press the case against repeating ruin without simply condemning a poor nation. Build it well, and the seabed governance, the coalition, the market, and the memory of phosphate become the community's genuine strength. One practical note on building this layer: the memory of phosphate is the element that most distinguishes a Nauruan case and most repays careful documentation, because it converts an abstract, contested argument about deep-sea risk into a concrete, visible, and morally undeniable one. The scientific case against deep-sea mining, though strong, is necessarily about an unseen realm and an uncertain future, and can be contested by those who insist the harm is speculative. But the case of phosphate is not speculative at all: it is written across four-fifths of a real island in jagged white stone that anyone can photograph and see, and its arc — the boom, the ruin, the bankruptcy — is a matter of documented history. Building this layer well means gathering that record fully: the images of the moonscape, the history of the century of extraction, the story of the squandered wealth, and the slow, hard work of rehabilitation. Marshalled together, this record turns the deep-sea question from an abstract dispute into a plain one — here is exactly what extraction did to this island; shall we do the same to the sea? — and that concrete, visible cautionary force is the most distinctive and persuasive thing a Nauruan case can carry.

WHAT TO GATHER, AND WHERE TO FIND IT

Evidence in hand beats evidence you assume exists. Here is where the material tends to live in a Nauruan effort, and how to get it — with the **risk**, the **governance**, the **memory**, and the **better path** at the center. Treat this as a checklist to work through, not a menu to admire.

The Project and Governance Record

Start with the project and its governance. **The sponsorship agreements, the company's plans, the seabed authority's records, and the exploration and exploitation framework** establish what is intended and how it is governed; the seabed authority's own documents, including its advisors' warnings, are largely public and reachable. Establish the **project, the area, the company, and the governance process** — the two-year push, the state of the regulations, the precautionary principle — because the governance is where the frontier is met.

The Deep-Sea Risk and Science Evidence

This is a heart of the file. Gather the **deep-sea science** — the studies of the nodule ecosystems, the warnings of severe, irreversible, and unpredictable harm, the vast scale and the slow formation of what would be destroyed — drawing on **the scientific literature, the seabed authority's advisors, and the deep-sea defence organisations**. This risk evidence is what establishes that the deep-sea harm is real, grave, and beyond repair, and it is the environmental core of the case.

The Memory of Phosphate and the Land

Document the island's own history, because it is the distinctive Nauruan lever. Gather the **record of phosphate** — the century of strip-mining, the ruined Topside, the moonscape of pinnacles, the boom and the bankruptcy, and the state of the **rehabilitation** — through the historical record, the photographs, and the rehabilitation bodies' work. And gather the **accountability precedent** — the reckoning with the past extractors and the settlement that funded rehabilitation. A community that can show its own island's ruin, and the reckoning that followed, holds the most powerful cautionary argument there is.

The Market, Coalition, and Better-Path Record

Document the frontier levers and the honest alternative. Gather the record of the **buyers who refuse seabed metals** and the industry initiatives against deep-sea mining; the **nations in the moratorium coalition**, including Pacific neighbours; and the **better paths** for Nauru's need — rehabilitation, sustainable revenue, accountability, adaptation. A community that can show a refusing market, a growing coalition, and real alternatives for the nation holds levers that both press the case and honour Nauru's need.

The Community — Local, Pacific, and Global

Finally, map the human terrain, which here is unusually broad. Who has a stake — the **Nauruans who question the path, the Pacific neighbours whose ocean is shared, the deep-sea's global defenders, and the future?** Who are the allies — the **deep-sea defence organisations, the moratorium-coalition governments, the scientists, the Pacific civil society, the refusing buyers?** And how is the case framed to honour Nauru's need while pressing against ruin? A Nauruan effort is advanced through a community that is local, regional, and global at once — so map that broad coalition deliberately, and hold the nation's need within it.

STEP 3: BUILDING LOCAL OPPOSITION

Here this step must be understood broadly, because the "community" in a Nauruan effort is unusually wide — the government drives the deep-sea project, so the opposition comes as much from the Pacific, the world, and the deep sea's defenders, and from those Nauruans who question the path, as from any organised domestic movement. The task is to build a community that is Nauruan, Pacific, and global at once, united by the memory of phosphate and the defence of the deep, and honouring Nauru's real need.

Why the Broad Community Is Decisive

In Nauru, the community that can act is broad, because the seabed is a global commons and the government champions the project. The broad community supplies what an effort runs on: the Nauruan voices who carry the memory of phosphate, the Pacific neighbours whose ocean is shared, the global defenders of the deep, and — distinctively — the moral authority of an island that has already been ruined by extraction and can testify against repeating it. When this broad community organises around the memory of phosphate and the defence of the deep, it becomes a genuine force. **The broad community here is not a single village but a circle widening from the ruined island to the shared Pacific to the global**

commons — united by the lesson of phosphate and the defence of the deep, and honouring the nation's real need — the distinctive and legitimate foundation of a Nauruan effort. This widening circle is not a weakness of the Nauruan case but its distinctive strength, and understanding why matters. In most struggles, the affected community is local and bounded, and its power comes from the density and unity of that local base; to disperse it would be to weaken it. Here the situation is inverted, because the resource at stake — the deep seabed — is legally the common heritage of all humanity, and the harm from mining it would fall not on one village but on an ecosystem and an ocean shared by all. This means the legitimate community of concern genuinely is the widening circle: the Nauruans who carry the lesson, the Pacific peoples whose ocean is shared, and the global public who inherit the deep. Far from diluting the cause, this breadth gives it a legitimacy and a reach that a purely local struggle could never have, for it can rightly summon the concern of the whole Pacific and the whole world to a frontier that belongs to all. An effort that understands and organises this widening circle — local memory at its heart, regional solidarity around it, global stake beyond — draws on a base as wide as the ocean itself.

Finding the Community

Begin with those who carry the memory and the stake — the **Nauruans who question repeating ruin, the Pacific neighbours whose ocean is shared, and the deep sea's global defenders.** Widen to all who have a stake in the deep, which — since the seabed is the common heritage of all humanity — is everyone. Name the shared stake — **the lesson of a ruined island, the shared Pacific, and the common heritage of the deep** — because the memory of what phosphate did to Nauru is a warning for the whole ocean, and the deep sea belongs to all. There is a rare moral power in this shared stake, because it unites a specific, visible tragedy with a universal, invisible one. The specific tragedy is Nauru's own: an island a visitor can walk across and see, in its jagged white pinnacles, exactly what a century of extraction leaves behind. The universal stake is the deep sea's: an ecosystem almost no one will ever see, forming over millions of years, that mining would damage beyond any repair, in waters that belong to no nation and to every person. To join these — to say that the visible ruin of one small island is a preview of the invisible ruin that could be done to the vast and shared deep — is to give people both something concrete they can grasp and something universal they can care about. An effort that names this joined stake, making the moonscape of Nauru the visible face of what is threatened in the unseen deep, can move both the heart, through the island's tangible wound, and the conscience, through the common heritage at risk.

Coalition-Building Across Scales

A community allied is stronger than a community alone, and in Nauru the coalition spans the island, the region, and the world. Reach to the **Nauruans who question the path**, with respect for the nation's real need; the **Pacific moratorium neighbours and civil society**; the **global deep-sea defence organisations and scientists**; and the **refusing buyers**. Frame the coalition around the memory of phosphate, the defence of the deep, and better paths for Nauru. Build breadth across scales — local, Pacific, global — and let the island's own cautionary history be the coalition's moral heart.

Sustaining the Effort

Nauruan efforts are sustained through the global attention on the frontier and the enduring lesson of phosphate. Keep the broad community **informed, connected, and respectful of Nauru's need**; mark real steps — a pause advanced, a nation joined to the coalition, a buyer's refusal secured, a stretch of land healed. And keep the effort grounded in the memory of phosphate and the defence of the deep, which unite the broad community. The effort that lasts is the one that stays broad and connected, carries the lesson of the ruined island, and offers the nation better paths even as it presses the case against repeating ruin.

Sustaining such an effort is helped, in the Nauruan case, by the way the frontier's global significance keeps the cause continually in the world's eye, giving a broad community renewable reasons to stay engaged. Because deep-sea mining is a genuinely global question — debated at the seabed authority, contested by dozens of nations, watched by scientists and campaigners worldwide — the Nauruan story does not fade into a purely local matter that the world forgets, but recurs on the world stage at each governance meeting, each new nation joining the coalition, each buyer's refusal, each scientific finding. This steady drumbeat of global attention renews a broad community's momentum in a way a local struggle rarely enjoys. The discipline is to connect the Nauruan memory of phosphate firmly to this ongoing global frontier debate, so that the cause rides the world's sustained attention to deep-sea mining, and the lesson of the ruined island is heard afresh at each turn of the global conversation.

STEP 4: LEGAL, REGULATORY & SEABED-GOVERNANCE CHALLENGES — THE SEABED AUTHORITY, THE PRECAUTIONARY PRINCIPLE, AND THE MARKET

This is where a Nauruan effort is realistically advanced — not against a government that drives the project, but through the **world's seabed authority, the precautionary principle, and the market** that governs and buys from the frontier, grounded in the memory of phosphate. Here the governance, environmental, and market levers come together, because in Nauru a deep-sea project pushed through a global authority and sold to a global market is met through that authority and that market.

Setting Expectations Honestly

First, the honest truth. The levers are **real but contested and evolving**. The seabed authority is **the arena, but its rules are unsettled and contested**; the precautionary principle is **powerful but not self-enforcing**; the moratorium coalition is **growing but not yet decisive**; and the market refusal is **real but incomplete**. What these levers realistically achieve is **the premature push slowed, precaution pressed, the economic case undercut, and the land healed** — real outcomes, if not a settled ban. Enter this front clear-eyed: the seabed governance, the precautionary principle, and the market are Nauru's distinctive levers, strongest when the **risk is clear, the science is invoked, and the memory of phosphate is present** — but Nauru's need is real, the government drives the project, and the seabed is a global commons.

The Seabed Authority and the Precautionary Principle

The first and most distinctive front is the seabed authority. The **world's seabed authority** governs mining of the deep ocean floor, the common heritage of all humanity, and is the arena where a premature push — forced through before the rules and the science are ready — can be met. Use the authority's process to press the **precautionary principle** and international environmental law: that mining should not proceed without adequate knowledge and safeguards, that the harm may be severe and irreversible, and that the two-year push is not due process. Engage the authority's proceedings, support the precautionary voices within it, and invoke its own advisors' warnings. This front is where the frontier is most directly governed, and where a premature rush can be slowed. It is worth being clear about both the power and the limits of the seabed-authority front, honestly. Its power is real: the authority is the one body with formal jurisdiction over mining the international deep, and it operates under a mandate that explicitly includes protecting the marine environment and honouring the common heritage of humanity, so a well-made precautionary case has a genuine institutional home there, and procedural pressure can genuinely slow a premature rush. Its limits are equally real: the authority's own rules for exploitation remain unsettled and contested, some within it

favour proceeding, and it has at times seemed as much a promoter of seabed mining as a guardian against it, so it cannot be relied upon alone to hold the line. Understanding both means engaging the authority seriously as the central governance arena while never depending on it exclusively — pairing the work there with the coalition of nations that can press it from outside, the market refusal that can make mining doubtful whatever the authority decides, and the public pressure that a contested global commons attracts.

The Moratorium Coalition and the Market

The second front is the coalition and the market. A **growing coalition of nations** — including Pacific neighbours — calls for a moratorium or precautionary pause until the science is ready; support and expand it, for it is a distinctive lever on the frontier. And the **market refusal** is the economic pressure point: buyers who refuse to purchase seabed metals undercut the whole commercial case for mining, so document and expand the refusal, and bring it to bear on the project's viability. Together, a coalition pressing for a pause and a market refusing the metal can render the frontier both governed and commercially doubtful.

The Memory of Phosphate and the Rehabilitation

The third front joins the cautionary memory and the constructive alternative. The **memory of phosphate** — Nauru's own ruin by extraction — is the moral and practical argument that runs through every front: a warning, from the island's own body, against repeating catastrophe on the sea. And the **rehabilitation of the ruined land, and the accountability of past extractors** — including the precedent of the settlement that funded the healing — are the constructive, better path: a way to honour Nauru's need through healing and reckoning rather than new ruin. Pursued together — the seabed authority, the precautionary principle, the coalition, the market, the memory of phosphate, and the rehabilitation — these fronts are how a community presses the case against repeating ruin, while honouring the nation's real need. It is worth understanding why these fronts reinforce one another so well in Nauru's particular situation. The seabed authority supplies the formal governance arena where a premature push can be procedurally slowed. The precautionary principle supplies the legal and moral standard — that mining should not proceed without adequate knowledge — that gives the pause its justification. The coalition supplies the political weight of nations, including Nauru's own Pacific neighbours, pressing for that pause. The market refusal supplies the economic pressure that makes the whole venture doubtful regardless of the governance. The memory of phosphate supplies the moral force that runs through all of them. And the rehabilitation supplies the constructive alternative that keeps the effort from being mere opposition. Each covers the others' limits: the authority where procedure matters, the precautionary principle where justification is needed, the coalition where political weight counts, the market where economics bites, the memory where moral force is decisive, and the rehabilitation where a better path must be shown. An effort that grasps this division of labour makes the fullest use of the several levers that a contested global frontier, and a scarred island's history, uniquely provide.

TURNING YOUR EVIDENCE INTO ARGUMENTS

Evidence does not speak for itself; you must aim it at each decider in the language that moves them. The same file of risk, memory, and refusal becomes different arguments for the seabed authority, the coalition, the market, and the world. Translate deliberately, and always honouring Nauru's need.

For the Seabed Authority

The seabed authority responds to **the precautionary principle, the science, and its own mandate**. Frame the project as a premature push that violates precaution: here is the irreversible risk, here is the missing

science, here is the two-year rush that is not due process. Give them the scientific warnings and their own advisors' cautions, and press for a precautionary pause until the science and safeguards are ready. Make it concrete: *here is the risk, here is the gap in knowledge, here is why precaution requires a pause*. This is the argument that governs the frontier.

For the Moratorium Coalition

The coalition responds to **the shared stake and the precautionary case**. Frame the project as a threat to the common heritage of the deep that a growing coalition rightly resists: here is why a pause serves the ocean and the world. Give them the science and the coalition's own momentum, and ask them to join, strengthen, and lead the call for a moratorium. A growing coalition of nations, especially Pacific neighbours, is a powerful, legitimate voice for a pause.

For the Market and the Buyers

The market responds to **its own commitments and reputation**. Frame the metal as a product the responsible market refuses: here is the deep-sea harm behind the "battery in a rock," and here are the buyers who already refuse it. Give them the risk and the refusal, and ask them to refuse the metal and undercut the case. A market that will not buy the metal makes the whole project doubtful, whatever the governance.

For the World and the Memory of Phosphate

The world responds to **the power of a ruined island's warning**. Translate the file into a story anyone can grasp: an island already reduced to a moonscape by mining, now preparing to do the same to the sea — a warning written in Nauru's own scarred land. Frame it as the lesson of phosphate, offered to the whole ocean. Keep it accurate; credibility is quickly tested. And honour Nauru's real need, so the story is fair.

The Golden Rule

Never fabricate, never exaggerate, and never simply condemn a poor nation. Your credibility is your greatest asset before the seabed authority, the coalition, and the world, and fairness to Nauru's real need is essential to it. State the risk precisely, invoke the memory of phosphate honestly, and offer better paths. A community that is precise, credible, and fair — pressing the case against ruin while honouring the nation's need — is far harder to dismiss than one that overreaches or condemns.

STEP 5: MEDIA STRATEGY

Media and attention convert your evidence into pressure — and here, distinctively, the story is a global-commons story with a haunting image at its heart: an island already ruined by mining, preparing to mine the sea. The story — the moonscape of Topside, the threatened deep, the lesson unheeded — is one that moves the Pacific and the world.

Why Media Matters

The seabed authority, the coalition, the market, and the world behave differently when the risk and the memory are visible. Media does three things here: it **informs and unites the broad community**, it **raises the stakes** for the seabed authority, the coalition, and the market, and it **connects the frontier to the memory of phosphate** — the warning written in a ruined island's land. Because the seabed is a global commons and the story is haunting, international media are a genuine, powerful lever here — an island that ruined itself by mining, now mining the sea, is a story that travels. And the image of Topside's moonscape is

a warning the world can see. This image is, in truth, the single most valuable communicative asset a Nauruan effort possesses, and it should be used deliberately and well. In a debate that is otherwise about an unseen deep and an uncertain future, the moonscape of Topside offers something rare: a photograph that shows, with no need of explanation, exactly what a century of mining does — a landscape of bare, jagged white pinnacles where a living island once was, stretching across most of a country. No argument about deep-sea risk, however sound, can match the immediate force of that image, because it collapses the whole abstract case into a single visible fact. An effort that pairs this image with the plain question it poses — this is what mining did to the land; shall we now do it to the sea? — gives the world a way to grasp the stakes instantly and viscerally, and hands the cause a piece of evidence whose power lies precisely in that it requires no expertise to understand.

Crafting Your Narrative

Lead with the memory of phosphate, the threatened deep, and the lesson. The strongest frame is concrete and haunting: *an island already reduced to a moonscape by a century of mining is now, needing revenue, preparing to open the deep sea to the same extraction — and a community, drawing on that hard lesson, is fighting to pause the rush before the science is ready and to offer a better path.* Put the ruined island and the threatened deep first, and the precautionary case and Nauru's real need close behind, because the memory of phosphate engages the world and the fairness keeps the community credible. Keep it scrupulously accurate; overstatement is quickly caught. The Nauruan story is powerful because the warning is written in the island's own scarred land.

Choosing Your Channels

Match the channel to the audience. **Nauruan and Pacific networks** for the island and the region; the **international environmental and news media** for the world, the coalition, and the market; the **scientific and ocean-defence platforms** for the deep-sea case; and the **seabed-governance forums** for the authority. Because the frontier answers to the world's governance and market as much as to any island, the international and Pacific channels matter greatly — the memory of phosphate and the defence of the global commons are the story's distinctive power.

A Few Cautions

Stay accurate, fair, and constructive — the goal is a precautionary pause, better paths, and a healed land, not a story that condemns a poor nation or exaggerates. Honour Nauru's real need in every telling, and hold the nation's need and the sea's protection together. Handle the government, the company, and the Pacific divisions factually and respectfully. And sustain the story through the ongoing frontier debate and the enduring lesson of phosphate. Above all, let the haunting warning of a ruined island carry the story, because that is where a Nauruan effort is strongest and most resonant.

EMAILS & LETTERS: TEMPLATES THAT WORK

Templates save time and prevent mistakes, but adapt every one — insert the real project, the real risk, and the real memory, keep it factual, and honour Nauru's need. Here the precautionary case, and the memory of phosphate, win.

8A: Requesting Information

Subject: Request for information — the deep-sea mining project and its risks

Dear [authority / body],

I am writing on behalf of [community / organisation] regarding the deep-sea mining project sponsored in the Clarion-Clipperton Zone. To understand and respond, we request the **project and sponsorship documents**, the **environmental assessments and risk analyses**, and the **governance and regulatory status**. We wish to ensure the precautionary principle is honoured and the deep sea protected.

We would be grateful for a response by [date].

Respectfully,

[Name, organisation, contact]

8B: Submission to the Seabed Authority

Subject: For a precautionary pause on deep-sea mining

To the [seabed authority],

We write regarding the premature push to open deep-sea mining before adequate rules and science are in place. We respectfully urge that the **precautionary principle** be honoured, that no exploitation proceed without sufficient knowledge and safeguards, and that the two-year mechanism not be allowed to force mining prematurely, given the warnings of severe and irreversible harm. We attach the scientific and governance documentation.

Respectfully,

[Name, organisation, contact]

8C: Letter to a Moratorium-Coalition Government

Subject: Joining and strengthening the call for a deep-sea pause

Dear [government / minister],

We write to urge you to join, strengthen, or lead the growing coalition of nations — including Pacific neighbours — calling for a moratorium or precautionary pause on deep-sea mining until the science and safeguards are ready. The common heritage of the deep, and the lesson of ruined islands, call for caution. We can provide the scientific case and the coalition's momentum.

Respectfully,

[Name, organisation, contact]

8D: Letter to a Buyer or Market Initiative

Subject: Refusing the metals of deep-sea mining

To [buyer / initiative],

The metals of deep-sea mining, marketed as a "battery in a rock," would be extracted at the cost of irreversible harm to poorly-understood deep-sea ecosystems. We respectfully urge you to join those buyers who refuse to purchase seabed-mined metals, and so to undercut the case for opening the deep. We attach the risk documentation.

Respectfully,

[Name, organisation, contact]

8E: Media Pitch

Subject: The island that ruined itself by mining is now mining the sea

Dear [journalist],

Nauru — an island four-fifths reduced to a moonscape by a century of phosphate mining — is now, needing revenue, the sponsoring state pushing to open the deep sea to the same extraction. There is a haunting global-commons story here of a lesson unheeded and a community fighting to pause the rush and offer a better path. We can provide the history, the science, and voices, told fairly and honouring Nauru's real need.

Sincerely,

[Name, organisation, contact]

8F: Letter Invoking the Memory of Phosphate

Subject: The lesson of our ruined land, offered to the sea

To [decision-maker],

Our island bears, in the moonscape of Topside, the written lesson of what extraction does: a century of phosphate mining left four-fifths of Nauru uninhabitable and the nation, after the boom, impoverished. We offer that hard lesson now to the question of the deep sea, and respectfully urge that it not be repeated on the ocean floor before the science is ready. We can share the history and the evidence.

Respectfully,

[Name, community, contact]

8G: Letter on Rehabilitation and a Better Path

Subject: Healing the land and better paths for our nation's need

Dear [government / partner / body],

We recognise our nation's real and pressing need for revenue. But rather than repeat extraction on the sea, we urge investment in **healing the ruined land** — the rehabilitation of Topside — in **sustainable revenue**, and in **accountability for past ruin**, as better paths to a future. We can provide proposals and welcome partnership toward a future that does not require new ruin.

Respectfully,

[Name, community, contact]

8H: Rallying the Broad Community

Subject: The lesson of our island, the defence of the deep — let us press it together

Dear friends,

Our island was ruined once by mining, and now the sea is threatened with the same. But together — Nauruan, Pacific, and global — by carrying the lesson of phosphate, pressing the seabed authority and the precautionary pause, enlisting the nations and the refusing market, and offering our nation better paths, we can press the case against repeating ruin. Let us honour our nation's real need while defending the deep

that belongs to all. Please join us: share the lesson, connect the allies, and add your voice.

With respect,

[Name, organisation]

IF YOU HAVE LITTLE TIME: THE RAPID-FIRE VERSION

Sometimes the frontier is moving fast — an application submitted, a governance deadline looming, a mining plan advancing — and you cannot run the full effort. Triage to the levers that work fastest here, which means the seabed governance, the coalition, and the science.

The First 48 Hours

Establish the essentials: **what is being pushed through, and what irreversible risk it carries**. Identify the immediate pressure point — an **application, a governance meeting, a two-year deadline, a mining plan** — because that is what you must affect first. Reach the **deep-sea defence organisations and the moratorium-coalition governments** at once, because in Nauru the seabed governance and the coalition are the fastest routes to real leverage — and invoke the **precautionary principle** and the **memory of phosphate** immediately.

The Fastest-Moving Levers

Some levers work faster than others. **The precautionary case** at the seabed authority can seek to slow a premature push quickly. **The moratorium coalition** can raise its voice fast at a governance moment. **The deep-sea science** and its warnings can be deployed at once. **The refusing market** can be invoked to cast doubt on the metal. These outpace the slower work of rehabilitation and long accountability — which continue in parallel — because the governance and coalition levers react to a governance moment.

Emergency Coalition-Building

You cannot build a full coalition overnight, but here you can reach the deep-sea defenders and the coalition governments fast. Reach immediately to the **deep-sea defence organisations, the moratorium-coalition governments, the scientists, and the Pacific civil society**. A community deploying the precautionary case and the science, backed by the coalition, at a governance moment, is the most a rapid Nauruan effort can do — and the governance lever can bite at the right moment. Speed favours the prepared: know the project, the science, and your allies before the deadline.

WHEN THE SYSTEM IS TILTED

Here, honestly, the system is tilted by a poor nation's real need, by a government that drives the project, by a powerful company, and by a global commons no single community controls. This is Nauru's central, honest truth, and the whole guide has been shaped by it. Name it plainly, because pretending the nation's need is not real, or that the government is not the driver, or that the seabed is any one community's, would be false.

Recognising a Tilted Field

The signs are specific and honest. **Nauru's need is real** — a poor, scarred nation with few options genuinely needs revenue. **The government drives the project** — the state itself sponsors the mining, so it is the project's champion. **The company is powerful** — a global mining venture with resources and reach.

The seabed is a global commons — no single community controls it, and the governance is contested. This is a tilt of poverty, sponsorship, and a contested commons, and an effort here works it through the world's governance and market, the coalition, and the island's own history, not by confronting a poor nation that sees the sea as its lifeline.

Strategies for a Tilted Field

When the field is tilted, use the global levers and honour the nation's need. Lean on the **seabed governance and the precautionary principle** that govern the frontier; the **moratorium coalition** that presses a pause; the **market refusal** that undercuts the case; the **deep-sea science** that establishes the risk; and the **memory of phosphate** that warns against ruin. Honour Nauru's **real need** by offering better paths — rehabilitation, sustainable revenue, accountability — so the effort is not a condemnation but an alternative. And build the case and the coalition over time, because a precautionary pause, a growing coalition, and a refusing market accumulate into real pressure on a contested frontier. A tilted field here is worked through the world's governance and the island's own wisdom, not against a poor nation's need.

The Honest Possibility of Losing

You may lose — the frontier may open, the mining may proceed — and this guide will not pretend otherwise; the nation's need is real, the government drives it, and the commons is contested. But here the work is rarely wholly wasted: the **risk was documented, the precautionary case made, the coalition grown, the market's refusal expanded, and the memory of phosphate carried to the world** — and every pause won, every buyer's refusal secured, every stretch of land healed protects the deep and the island alike. Press for the pause; if the frontier opens, the precautionary case you built, the coalition you grew, and the lesson of phosphate you carried will press it still, because on a frontier this new and this contested, the case for caution, once made, does not go away.

WHEN IT'S ACTUAL CORRUPTION — AND WHO IS CAPTURED

In Nauru, the honest reckoning with capture runs two ways: the historical squandering of the phosphate wealth, when a fortune that should have secured the nation's future was lost to mismanagement, and the present risk that a small, dependent state's deep-sea sponsorship may serve a foreign company's interests more than its people's. This must be approached with care and fairness, and the route runs through transparency, accountability, and the international bodies.

Telling Capture from the Ordinary Tilt

A poor nation seeking revenue is the ordinary tilt; where a nation's resource wealth is squandered or its sovereignty leveraged for a foreign company's gain, that is capture. The marks are specific: **resource wealth lost to mismanagement rather than securing the future, sponsorship arrangements that serve the company more than the people, opaque deals and dependencies, and benefits that do not reach the nation**. Be rigorous and fair: **distinguish a poor nation's genuine need from provable capture or mismanagement**, and do not condemn where the evidence is only of hard choices — but where wealth was squandered or sovereignty is being leveraged for a foreign gain, transparency and accountability are the tools, and the phosphate era's hard lesson is itself a warning.

Responding to Capture — Through Transparency

Where capture or mismanagement is real, the response runs through transparency and accountability. Use the **transparency and financial-accountability bodies** to scrutinise the sponsorship and the flows. Use

the **accountability precedent** — the reckoning with the past extractors that funded rehabilitation — as a model for holding present actors to account. Use the **international and Pacific bodies** to press for arrangements that serve the nation, not a foreign company. Document carefully and fairly, and route the scrutiny through the transparency and international channels, which can pursue what a small, dependent state may not pursue alone.

A Note on Safety and Care

Nauru is a small democracy, not a police state, so open advocacy is broadly possible, and the danger here is less physical than in more repressive places. But it is a tiny society where relationships are close and dissent can carry social and political cost, and where the nation's real need makes the debate sensitive, so act with care and respect. Treat those who support the deep-sea project, out of genuine concern for the nation's future, as neighbours to persuade, not enemies to defeat; honour the nation's need; and keep the effort fair, constructive, and focused on better paths. Care here means respecting a small society's bonds and a poor nation's genuine dilemma — because the goal is not to shame Nauru but to help it avoid repeating its own catastrophe, and that goal is served by fairness, not condemnation.

INTEGRATION & TIMELINE: RUNNING ALL FIVE STEPS TOGETHER

The steps in this guide are written in sequence but run in parallel, each feeding the others. Here is how they fit into a single, fair effort in Nauru.

The Parallel Effort

From the start, the five run together. **Documentation** builds the risk-memory-and-refusal file. **Target identification** aims it at the levers. **Local opposition** builds the broad community — Nauruan, Pacific, global. **Legal, regulatory, and seabed-governance** work presses the authority, the precautionary principle, and the market. **Media** carries the memory of phosphate to the world. The risk, the memory, and the refusal feed all five at once — a documented risk is a governance submission, a coalition case, a market appeal, and a global story together. Run in parallel, they compound; run one at a time, they stall — and here, spanning a ruined island and the global deep, they compound into a global-commons cause.

A Rough Timeline

Early (weeks 1–8): establish the risk, the science, and the memory of phosphate; identify the seabed authority's process, the coalition, the refusing market, and the rehabilitation; begin documentation. **Middle (months 2–18):** press the seabed authority and the precautionary principle; grow the moratorium coalition; expand the market refusal; and advance rehabilitation and accountability, while offering Nauru better paths. **Later (months and years):** press for a lasting precautionary pause, expand the coalition and the refusal, heal the land, and keep offering better paths whatever the frontier's course. A Nauruan effort is patient, and its work — governing a contested frontier and healing a ruined land — is long; pace it accordingly, and honour the nation's need throughout.

The Core Discipline

Through it all, hold the discipline that gives these efforts their force: **document the risk and invoke the memory of phosphate; press the seabed governance, the coalition, and the market; heal the land and press accountability; and hold the nation's need and the sea's protection together.** The community that presses all five, spanning a ruined island and the global deep, and honouring the nation's

real need, is the one that can genuinely press the case against repeating ruin — the kind of victory a poor, scarred nation on a contested frontier allows.

FINAL ASSESSMENT

Opposing the repetition of ruin in Nauru is genuinely difficult, and bound up with a poor nation's real need, a government that drives the project, a powerful company, and a global commons no one community controls, and this guide has been honest about that from its first line: there is no landmark victory, Nauru's need is real, and its own government sponsors the deep-sea push. And yet the effort is far from futile, because Nauru has already lived the full catastrophe of extraction and carries its warning in its own scarred land, and because the deep-sea frontier runs through the world's seabed governance, a growing coalition, a precautionary principle, and a market that refuses to buy — and those levers, and the memory of phosphate, are real.

Some honest truths hold across every effort here. **The memory of phosphate is the distinctive, lived argument — a nation ruined by extraction is the living case against repeating it. The seabed governance, the coalition, and the market can slow the push and undercut its case. The rehabilitation and accountability offer a better, constructive path. But Nauru's need is real, the government drives the project, and the seabed is a global commons.** Hold both truths at once: real, distinctive, global-commons levers and a lived cautionary memory, and the honest weight of a poor nation's need and a government that drives the project.

Above all, keep the discipline — and the fairness — that give these efforts their force. Document the risk and invoke the memory of phosphate. Press the seabed governance, the coalition, and the market. Heal the land and press accountability. And hold the nation's need and the sea's protection together — because for a nation already ruined once by extraction, an effort that presses the case against repeating it while honouring the nation's real need and offering better paths is the one that is both effective and just.

Nauru is a tiny island in the vast Pacific, and it bears in the moonscape of its interior the written record of what a century of mining did to it — four-fifths of the land reduced to jagged pinnacles, the people crowded on a thin coastal ring, a nation that was briefly rich left poor and scarred — and now, its old income gone, it has become the state that pushes the world toward opening the deep sea to the very same extraction; this guide has hidden none of it, nor pretended that a poor and ruined nation does not genuinely need a future, or that the seabed is any one community's to decide, and there is no landmark community victory here to promise you. But Nauru's own history is the most powerful argument there is: an island that ruined itself by mining is the living warning against doing the same to the sea, and that warning, carried through the world's seabed governance, the growing coalition of nations, the precautionary principle, the market that will not buy, and the healing of the ruined land, is a real and reaching lever. There is no easy victory, and no landmark precedent to inherit; this guide has said so throughout, and insisted on honouring the nation's real need. But the deep sea that belongs to all, and the lesson written in a ruined island's land, are worth defending, the levers that reach a global frontier are real, and the patient work of documenting the risk, carrying the memory of phosphate, pressing the seabed governance and the refusing market, and healing the land is one a community — Nauruan, Pacific, and global — can genuinely do, and press the case against repeating ruin. So can you.